

LINKS GOLF MAJOR

July 16–19, 2026 · Southport, England · \$1,000 Bankroll · fully deployed (6 outright + 5 top-10 props)



FINAL — RYAN FOX WINS THE OPEN AT −10 · BIRDIE ON THE 72ND · 9 OF 11 BETS GRADED · UPDATED SUN JUL 19, ~1:30 PM CT

Ryan Fox is the Champion Golfer of the Year. The New Zealander holed a 12-footer for birdie on the 72nd hole to win at −10 by one — his maiden major — as Si Woo Kim faded to −6 in the wind. Final board (AP + Bleacher Report agree): **1. Fox −10 · 2. Young −9 · 3. Burns −8 · T4 Scheffler −7 · T4 Fleetwood −7 · T6 Jarvis, Herbert, Kim −6.** OUR CARD: **all six outright** **LOSE (−\$600)** — none of ours ever caught the leaders — and the 🧠 **Koepka +5000 longshot is a MISS (0-for-6 on longshots, one HIT).** The Phase 2 hedge did its job: **Scheffler top-10 CASHES (+\$82.19)** and **Fleetwood top-10 CASHES (+\$142.20),** both T4; Fitzpatrick's top-10 died with Friday's missed cut (−\$70). **Card −\$445.61 through 9 of 11 grades.** Still pending: **Rahm and Morikawa top-10 props (\$120 staked)** — both finished outside the published top-8; they grade off the full verified final board on the next update.

156 players

FIELD · 4 ROUNDS

Royal Birkdale

FIRST OPEN HERE SINCE 2017

Scheffler

DEFENDING CHAMPION

FOX −10

CHAMPION · 9/11 GRADED



HOW THIS CARD WORKS — TWO-PHASE BUILD

Golf majors settle over four days against a 156-man field — even the favorite is only ~15% to win, so an outright card is a **basket of longshots by nature**. Phase 1: \$600 across six outright, odds locked at build. Phase 2 (deployed Wednesday, before the first tee): **\$400 across five top-10 finish props** on our basket players — the higher-probability side of golf betting, where a top-10 cashes when our guy merely contends rather than has to win outright.

OUTRIGHT BOARD (DK / CONSENSUS AT BUILD)

Scottie Scheffler (def. champ)	+450	Rory McIlroy	+750
Jon Rahm	+1600	Tommy Fleetwood (Southport)	+1600
Xander Schauffele ('24 champ)	+1600	Matt Fitzpatrick	+2000
Cameron Young	+2500	Collin Morikawa ('21 champ)	+2800
Viktor Hovland	+3000	Brooks Koepka	+5000

THE ANGLES

SCHEFFLER +450 · THE ANCHOR

WORLD NO. 1 · DEFENDING OPEN CHAMPION

- ▶ Best player alive, though winless in 13 starts — the price got longer than his true chance
- ▶ Opened +400, drifted to +450; markets over-punish "droughts" for elite iron players
- ▶ Links golf rewards flushed irons + flighted wedges — his exact profile

Est. win: 18% vs ~15% market — the rare positive-EV favorite

FLEETWOOD +1600 · THE HOMETOWN STORY WITH TEETH

BORN IN SOUTHPORT — BIRKDALE IS LITERALLY HIS HOME COURSE

- ▶ Grew up playing Royal Birkdale; no player knows these dunes better
- ▶ Elite links pedigree: multiple top-fives in Opens, best ball-striking season of his career
- ▶ The narrative price and the golf price agree for once

Est. win: 7% vs 5.9% market

THE ENGLISH CONTINGENT

FITZPATRICK +2000 · HOME MAJOR MOTIVATION

- ▶ Fitzpatrick: three wins this season, best year of his career, home country major
- ▶ Knock: 94th in strokes-gained putting — links greens neutralize that gap
- ▶ Rahm +1600: two-time major champ, near-misses at both 2026 majors, built for wind

Rahm est. 7% · Fitzpatrick est. 5.5% — both above market

MORIKAWA + THE LONGSHOT

PROVEN OPEN WINNERS AT LONG PRICES

- ▶ Morikawa +2800: 2021 Open champion, just shot a Sunday 61 at Travelers
- ▶ Koepka +5000: five majors, big-game hunter, priced at career-long odds
- ▶ Majors are where Koepka's focus shows up — 50/1 is a stats-vs-narrative bet

Morikawa est. 4.5% · Koepka est. 2.5% — the 🧠 longshot lives here

\$1,000 BANKROLL ALLOCATION

TOTAL BUDGET

\$1,000

\$600 on 6 outright + \$400 on 5 top-10 props · fully deployed

BASKET COVERAGE

~44%

chance one of our six lifts the Claret Jug

★ PHASE 1 · OUTRIGHT WINNER BASKET (MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE — MAX ONE CASHES)

PICK	ODDS	STAKE	EST. WIN	TO WIN	TYPE
1 · Scottie Scheffler Defending champ · FINAL: T4 at −7 — three back of Fox	+450	\$200	18% mkt 15%	LOSS − \$200	ANCHOR
2 · Jon Rahm Two majors · FINAL: OB at the 1st Sunday, never contended	+1600	\$100	7% mkt 5.9%	LOSS − \$100	VALUE
3 · Tommy Fleetwood Southport native · FINAL: T4 at −7 on his home links	+1600	\$100	7% mkt 5.9%	LOSS − \$100	HOME TURF
4 · Matt Fitzpatrick 3 wins this season · MISSED CUT Friday (72-72, +4)	+2000	\$80	5.5% mkt 4.8%	LOSS −\$80	VALUE
5 · Collin Morikawa 2021 Open champ · FINAL: never in the weekend picture	+2800	\$70	4.5% mkt 3.4%	LOSS −\$70	VALUE
6 · 🧠 Brooks Koepka The longshot · FINAL: MISS — longshot record 0-for-6, 1 HIT	+5000	\$50	2.5% mkt 2%	MISS −\$50	LONGSHOT

PHASE 2 · TOP-10 PROPS · DEPLOYED WED JUL 15 · \$400

7 · Scottie Scheffler — Top 10 World No. 1 · FINAL: T4 −7 — top-10 CASHED ✓	-146	\$120	62% mkt 59%	WON +\$82.19	ANCHOR
8 · Tommy Fleetwood — Top 10 Southport native · FINAL: T4 −7 — top-10 CASHED ✓	+158	\$90	44% mkt 39%	WON +\$142.20	VALUE
9 · Jon Rahm — Top 10 Elite wind player · outside published top-8 — awaiting full final board	+172	\$80	42% mkt 37%	+\$137.60 PENDING	VALUE
10 · Matt Fitzpatrick — Top 10 English · streak snapped — MISSED CUT, prop dead x	+164	\$70	42% mkt 38%	LOSS −\$70 (MC)	VALUE
11 · Collin Morikawa — Top 10 2021 Open champ · outside published top-8 — awaiting full final board	+280	\$40	30% mkt 26%	+\$112.00 PENDING	VALUE

Portfolio note. The six outright are mutually exclusive — at most one cashes, but any one of them pays for the entire card several times over (Scheffler +\$900 minimum, Koepka +\$2,500 maximum). Combined coverage: ~44% that one of ours wins the Jug. The \$400 Phase 2 deployment — five top-10 props across the basket — is the higher-probability hedge: a top-10 cashes when our guy contends, not only when he lifts the Jug. Scheffler's is near-even money; the other four carry plus-money value. **McIlroy +750 is our biggest deliberate fade** — playing too infrequently this year to trust at half Fleetwood's price.

ALLOCATION SUMMARY

\$1,000

FULLY DEPLOYED

11

BETS (6 + 5 PROPS)

~44%

BASKET COVERAGE

−\$445.61

CARD P/L · 9/11 GRADED

Fictitious \$1,000 bankroll test — no real money wagered. For entertainment purposes only.

Odds: DraftKings / consensus boards + Golf Digest reporting, locked at build (Sun Jul 12). Phase 2 props added Wednesday Jul 15. Graded Sunday Jul 19 (9/11 · Fox wins at −10, verified AP + Bleacher Report) · Rahm/Morikawa top-10s pending full board · tracked in betting_tracker.xlsx, tab "The Open".